

- 103.** In the context of the passage, what does 'regression' mean?
- Lack of desire to improve the reading speed
 - Looking back at what is already read
 - Lack of proper understanding of what one reads
 - Comparing the reading speed of school and university students
- 104.** In order to be a good reader you should
- regress whenever necessary
 - be like a careful driver
 - not look back frequently while reading
 - test your vocabulary frequently
- 105.** According to the author reading with regression is like
- driving with poor quality brakes
 - stepping backwards while walking
 - using several brakes in order to slow down
 - making sudden spurts in reading speed

PASSAGE 31

Even in the most primitive societies the great majority of people satisfy a large part of their material needs by exchanging goods and services. Very few people indeed can make for themselves everything they need—all their food, their clothes, their housing, their tools. Ever since men started living in communities, they have been satisfying their needs by means of specialisation and exchange, increasingly each individual has concentrated on what he can do best and has produced more of the special goods or services in which he has concentrated, than he can consume himself. The surplus he has exchanged with other members of the community, acquiring, in exchange the things he needs that others have produced.

- 106.** Very few people can satisfy their needs today by
- providing things for themselves
 - exchanging goods and services
 - concentrating on what they can do best
 - individual specialisation
- 107.** Exchange of goods becomes possible only when
- there is no specialisation
 - goods are produced in surplus
 - primitive societies become modern
 - individuals make things for themselves
- 108.** Specialisation and exchange began when men started
- big industries
 - concentrating on their work
 - producing things for individual use
 - living in communities

- 109.** Exchange of goods and services becomes necessary because
- man is a social being
 - reciprocity is the law of life
 - trade and commerce are means of progress
 - we cannot produce everything we need ourselves

PASSAGE 32

Soil scientists have shown that the soil teems with millions of living things, many of them useful, others harmful. The living things which are useful include earthworms and various kinds of bacteria. Earthworms loosen the soil and so enable air and water to enter it. Bacteria, which are microscopic living things breakdown dead plants and animals and make humus, or take nitrogen from the air and change it into substances that plants use.

The living things that do harm include other bacteria and fungi which cause diseases. Other harmful things are pests such as wire worms which feed on the roots of grass and other plants. While the farmer can usually keep weeds in check by careful cultivation, this alone may not protect his crops from insects, pests and diseases. Now-a-days, however, he is much better able to control these enemies. He may plant specially resistant types of seeds or he may keep the pests and diseases in check with chemicals. With better seeds farmers have been able to increase their crop yields. They can grow crops that ripen more quickly and have a stronger resistance to disease, frost or drought.

- 110.** Scientists who study soil believe that
- all insects and bacteria are harmful
 - only microscopic living things are useful
 - only earthworms are useful
 - not all worms and bacteria are harmful
- 111.** The living things that do harm
- break down plants and animals
 - use up the nitrogen from the air
 - cause diseases in the plants
 - loosen up the soil from air and water
- 112.** Farmers are always careful
- to control insects and fungi that attack plants
 - to encourage pests in the soil
 - to eliminate all bacteria from the soil
 - to foster all kinds of worms in the earth
- 113.** Now-a-days, it is possible to reduce the loss caused by pests and harmful bacteria
- with the use of chemical fertilizers
 - through the development of resistant seeds
 - by using weeds as killers
 - by controlling earthworms
- 114.** The farmers today can also select seeds
- of slow ripening variety
 - resistant to frost and drought
 - for economy in costs
 - of lower resistance to disease

2015 (I)

PASSAGE 33

A little man beside me was turning over the pages of a magazine quickly and nervously. Opposite me, there was a young mother who was trying to restrain her son from making a noise. The boy had obviously grown weary of waiting. He had placed an ashtray on the floor and was making aeroplane noises as he waved a pencil in his hands. Near him, an old man was fast asleep, snoring quickly to himself and the boy's mother was afraid that sooner or later her son would wake the gentleman up.

- 115.** The noise was made by the
(a) old man (b) aeroplane (c) little man (d) boy
- 116.** The person who was the least disturbed was the
(a) observer (b) son (c) old man (d) little man
- 117.** The factor common to all the people was that they were all
(a) watching a film
(b) waiting for something
(c) looking at the little boy's playfulness
(d) reading magazine
- 118.** Among those present the one who appeared to be the most bored was the
(a) child (b) little man (c) old man (d) mother

PASSAGE 34

A man had two blacksmiths for his neighbours. Their names were Pengu and Shengu. The man was greatly troubled by the noise of their hammers. He decided to talk to them. The next day, he called both of them and offered ₹ 100 each, if they found new huts for themselves. They took the money and agreed to find new huts for themselves. The next morning, he woke up again to the sound of their hammers. He went out to see why the blacksmiths hadn't found new huts and he discovered that Pengu and Shengu had kept their promise. They had exchanged their huts.

- 119.** The man was troubled because
(a) the blacksmiths always fought with each other
(b) the blacksmiths' hammers made a lot of noise
(c) he was afraid of blacksmiths
(d) the blacksmiths did not do their work properly
- 120.** The man gave them money because
(a) the blacksmiths were poor
(b) the blacksmiths had asked him for money
(c) he did not want them to make a noise
(d) he wanted them to find new huts
- 121.** The man went out of his house because
(a) he wanted to fight with the blacksmiths
(b) he wanted to ask the blacksmiths to stop the noise
(c) he wanted to find out why they hadn't found new huts
(d) he wanted his money back from the blacksmiths

- 122.** The man came to know that
(a) the blacksmiths were not in their huts
(b) the blacksmiths had exchanged their huts
(c) the blacksmiths were going away
(d) the blacksmiths had not kept their promise

PASSAGE 35

The tigress was a mile away and the ground between her and us was densely wooded, scattered over with great rocks and cut up by a number of deep ravines, but she could cover the distance well within the half-hour—if she wanted to.

The question I had to decide was, whether or not I should try to call her. If I called and she heard me, and came while it was still daylight and gave me a chance to shoot her, all would be well; on the other hand, if she came and did not give me a shot, some of us would not reach camp, for we had nearly two miles to go and the path the whole way ran through heavy jungle.

- 123.** According to the author,
(a) the tigress wanted to cover the distance within the half-hour
(b) the tigress did not wish to cover the distance within the half-hour
(c) the tigress actually covered the distance within the half-hour
(d) there was a possibility of the tigress covering the distance within the half-hour
- 124.** The author says, "Some of us would not reach camp", because
(a) it was two miles away
(b) the tigress would kill some of them
(c) the path is not suitable for walking
(d) the ground was scattered over with great rocks
- 125.** The author found it difficult to decide the question because
(a) he was afraid
(b) the tigress was only a mile away
(c) the ground between them was densely wooded
(d) there was uncertainty about the reaction of the tigress to his call
- 126.** The time available to the author for shooting the tigress was
(a) the whole day (b) one night
(c) a few hours (d) 30 minutes
- 127.** When the author says 'all would be well', he means
(a) that they would be able to hide themselves in the heavy jungle
(b) that the tigress would run away to the deep ravines
(c) that they would be able to shoot her down without difficulty
(d) that they would be able to return in daylight

PASSAGE 36

After lunch, I felt at a loose end and roamed about the little flat. It suited us well enough when mother was with me, but now I was by myself, it was too large and I'd moved the dining room table into my bedroom. That was now, the only room I used; it had all the furniture I needed; a brass bedstead, a dressing table, some cane chairs whose seats had more or less caved in, a wardrobe with a tarnished mirror. The rest of the flat was never used, so I didn't trouble to look after it.

- 128.** The flat did not really suit him any more because
 (a) the rooms were too small
 (b) he was living on his own now
 (c) his mother needed too much rooms
 (d) the flat itself was too little
- 129.** He did not look after the rest of the flat because
 (a) he did not use it
 (b) the bedroom was too much large
 (c) he needed only the brass bedstead
 (d) he had too much furniture
- 130.** "..... now I was by myself, it was too large". The word *it* here refers to the
 (a) dining room table (b) dining room
 (c) bedroom (d) flat
- 131.** From the passage, we learn that the writer was
 (a) scared of living alone in the flat
 (b) dissatisfied with the flat
 (c) satisfied with the space in his bedroom
 (d) an eccentric person
- 132.** "After lunch I felt at a loose end" means
 (a) he had nothing specific to do
 (b) had a rope with a loose end
 (c) had much work to do
 (d) had a feeling of anxiety
- 133.** According to the passage, most of us prefer films which
 (a) overwhelm our imagination
 (b) depict our times
 (c) fulfil our secret wishes
 (d) appeal to our reason
- 134.** By watching thrilling adventures in films, we make up for the
 (a) effectiveness of our desires
 (b) shortcomings in our life
 (c) stimulation of our everyday life
 (d) influence which we don't have
- 135.** Film stars present situations
 (a) which are familiar to us, the city dwellers
 (b) which we have seen only in jungles
 (c) which we meet everyday at work
 (d) which excite us
- 136.** Whether we admit it to ourselves or not, we are aware that we are
 (a) weak and plain
 (b) both powerful and handsome
 (c) as strong as film heroes
 (d) more beautiful than film stars
- 137.** The daily life of students, office-goers and housewives is
 (a) full of new adventures
 (b) the same dull repetition
 (c) stimulating to their imagination
 (d) very exciting to them

2015 (II)

PASSAGE 38

Much rhapsodical nonsense has been written about the 'Mona Lisa' and her enigmatic smile, and there have been endless speculations as to her character and the meaning of her expression. It is all beside the mark. The truth is that the 'Mona Lisa' is a study of modeling. Leonardo da Vinci had discovered that the expression of smiling is much more a matter of modeling of the cheek and of the forms below the eye than of the change in the line of the lips. It interested him to produce a smile wholly by these delicate changes of surface; hence the mysterious expression.

- 138.** The word 'rhapsodical' as used in the passage means
 (a) plain (b) unreadable
 (c) enthusiastic (d) uniformed
- 139.** 'Mona Lisa' is the name of
 (a) a beautiful woman who made history in ancient Rome
 (b) a famous painting
 (c) the artist's mistress
 (d) an art technique
- 140.** The truth about the 'Mona Lisa' is that it is a study in
 (a) feminine psychology (b) facial expression
 (c) feminine form (d) modeling

PASSAGE 37

The overwhelming vote given by the greater part of the public has so far been in favour of films which pass the time easily and satisfy that part of our imagination which depends on the more obvious kind of daydreams. We make up for what we secretly regard as our deficiencies by watching the stimulating adventures of the other people who are stronger, more effective, or more beautiful than we are. The conventional stars act out our daydreams for us in a constant succession of exciting situations set in the open spaces, in the jungles or in the underworld of great cities which abounds in crime and violence. We would not dare to be in such situations but the situations are very exciting to watch since our youth is being spent in day-to-day routine of school, office or home.

- 141.** The painter was able to produce that strange smile on Mona Lisa's face by
- (a) delicate changes on the surface of cheeks below the eyes
 - (b) using bright colours
 - (c) using a painting knife
 - (d) looking constantly at a smiling model while painting
- 142.** The author of the above passage has examined 'Mona Lisa' from
- (a) an idealistic angle
 - (b) an imaginary point of view
 - (c) a purely artistic angle
 - (d) a scientific and realistic standpoint

PASSAGE 39

It is possible to give wedding presents, birthday and Christmas presents, without any thought of affection at all, they can be ordered by postcard; but the unbirthday present demands the nicest care. It is therefore the best of all and it is the only kind to which the golden rule of present-giving imperatively applies. The golden rule which insists that you must never give to another person anything that you would not rather keep: nothing that does not cost you a pang to part from. It would be better if this rule governed the choice also of those other three varieties of gifts, but they can be less exacting.

- 143.** The author says that wedding, birthday and Christmas presents
- (a) are always indicators of the giver's affection
 - (b) may not always be given with any thought of affection
 - (c) are given only to flatter the recipient
 - (d) are given only to fulfil an obligation
- 144.** 'They can be ordered by postcard' means that
- (a) the present may only be a postcard
 - (b) the present would be an expensive one
 - (c) the choice does not involve much care
 - (d) the present would not be worth giving
- 145.** The 'unbirthday' present is the best of all because
- (a) it cannot be ordered by postcard
 - (b) it means giving expensive presents
 - (c) its choice needs the utmost care
 - (d) other occasions are better than birthdays for giving presents
- 146.** A 'golden rule' is a rule which
- (a) brings profit
 - (b) is very important
 - (c) is very difficult
 - (d) is very easy
- 147.** The writer is of the view that one should give a present that
- (a) one would like to possess oneself
 - (b) one would like to get rid of
 - (c) cannot be ordered by mail
 - (d) is highly expensive and attractive

PASSAGE 40

People project their mental processes into their handwriting. They subconsciously shape and organise their letters, words and lines in ways that directly reflect their personalities. This explains why not two handwritings are or even can be alike; the medium is just too personal. Everyday observation confirms the link between handwriting and personality, at least in an elementary way. Precise people construct their words with care, slowly and exactly; dynamic people dash them off. Flamboyant people boldly cover half a page with a few words and a signature, whose size fittingly reflects their expansive sense of self. Most of us have made such observations. But it takes a practiced eye to discern the scores of variations and interpret the subtle interplay of forces at work in any given handwriting. In fact in Europe, handwriting analysis known as graphology, now enjoys scientific acceptance and common use.

- 148.** If you are a showy and colourful person, your handwriting is likely to be
- (a) neat and slow
 - (b) dashing and careless
 - (c) bold and large
 - (d) legible but small
- 149.** Graphology is
- (a) the study of graphs
 - (b) the analysis of handwriting
 - (c) a special branch of phonetics
 - (d) a graphical description of handwriting
- 150.** Handwriting analysis is
- (a) not useful to us
 - (b) an elementary study
 - (c) an imprecise science
 - (d) a means of studying personality
- 151.** According to the author, people are
- (a) not conscious of what they write
 - (b) aggressive in the nature of their writing
 - (c) not conscious of the way they write
 - (d) not used to personal writing
- 152.** The fact that handwriting is related to personality
- (a) has been noticed by most people
 - (b) is appreciated by dynamic people
 - (c) is restricted to persons who write carefully
 - (d) is known only to graphologists

PASSAGE 41

The simplest method of welding two pieces of metal together is known as pressure welding. The ends of metal are heated to a white heat—for iron, the welding temperature should be about 1300°C—in a flame. At this temperature the metal becomes plastic. The ends are then pressed or hammered together and the joint is smoothed off. Care must be taken to ensure that the surfaces are thoroughly cleaned first, for dirt will weaken the weld. Moreover, the heating of iron or steel to a high temperature causes oxidation, and a film of oxide is formed on the heated surfaces.

For this reason, a flux is applied to the heated metal. At welding heat, the flux melts, and the oxide particles are dissolved in it together with any other impurities which may be present. The metal surfaces are pressed together, and the flux is squeezed out from the centre of the weld. A number of different types of weld may be used, but for fairly thick bars of metals, a vee-shaped weld should normally be employed. It is rather stronger than the ordinary butt weld.

- 153.** The simplest way of welding two pieces of metal together is
- (a) heating the metal
 - (b) holding it in a flame
 - (c) coating the metal with plastic
 - (d) hammering heated pieces
- 154.** Unless the surfaces are cleaned first,
- (a) the metal will not take white heat
 - (b) the resulting weld will be weak
 - (c) the joint will be rough
 - (d) the metal will be less plastic
- 155.** When iron is heated to about 1300 degree centigrade,
- (a) flames turn from white to blue
 - (b) chemical reaction starts
 - (c) oxide film is found on its surfaces
 - (d) it turns into steel
- 156.** The flux is used to
- (a) make the metal plastic
 - (b) cool the heated metal
 - (c) cover up any dirt
 - (d) dissolve oxide and other impurities
- 157.** For fairly thick bars of metals
- (a) a vee-shaped weld should be used
 - (b) an ordinary butt weld should be used
 - (c) a number of different types of weld may be used
 - (d) a pressure weld may be used

2016 (I)

PASSAGE 42

To avoid the various foolish opinions to which mankind is prone, no superhuman brain is required. A few simple rules will keep you, not from all errors, but from silly errors.

If the matter is one that can be settled by observation, make the observation yourself. Aristotle could have avoided the mistake of thinking that women have fewer teeth than men, by the simple device of asking Mrs Aristotle to keep her mouth open while he counted. Thinking that you know, when in fact you do not, is a bad mistake to which we are all prone. I believe myself that hedgehogs eat black beetles, because I have been told that they do; but if I were writing a book on the habits of hedgehogs, I should not commit myself until I had seen one enjoying this diet.

Aristotle, however, was less cautious. Ancient and medieval writers knew all about unicorns and salamanders; not one of them thought it necessary to avoid dogmatic statements about them because he had never seen one of them.

- 158.** The writer believes that
- (a) most people could avoid making foolish mistakes if they were clever
 - (b) through observation we could avoid making many mistakes
 - (c) Aristotle made many mistakes because he was not observant
 - (d) all errors are caused by our own error in thinking
- 159.** With reference to the passage, which one of the following is the correct statement?
- (a) Aristotle was able to avoid the mistake of thinking that women have fewer teeth than men
 - (b) Aristotle thought women have fewer teeth than men
 - (c) Aristotle proved that women have fewer teeth by counting his wife's teeth
 - (d) Aristotle may have thought that women have fewer teeth because he never had a wife
- 160.** The writer says that if he was writing a book on hedgehogs,
- (a) he would maintain that they eat black beetles because he had been told so
 - (b) he would first observe their eating habits
 - (c) he would think it unnecessary to verify that they ate black beetles
 - (d) he would make the statement that they ate black beetles and later verify it
- 161.** The writer is of the opinion that
- (a) unicorns and salamanders were observed by ancient and medieval writers but were unknown to modern writers
 - (b) ancient and medieval writers wrote authoritatively about unicorns and salamanders though they had never seen them
 - (c) unicorns and salamanders do not exist
 - (d) only those who had observed the habits of unicorns and salamanders wrote about them

- 162.** A 'dogmatic statement' in the context means a statement which is

- (a) convincing
- (b) proved
- (c) unquestionable
- (d) doubtful

PASSAGE 43

Since I had nothing better to do, I decided to go to the market to buy a few handkerchiefs, the old ones had done vanishing trick. On the way I met an old friend of mine and I took him to a nearby restaurant for tea and snacks. Afterwards, I went to the shop and selected a dozen handkerchiefs. I pulled out my purse to make the payment and discovered that it was empty; I then realised that it was not my purse. It was a different purse altogether. How that happened is still a source of wonder to me and I refuse to believe that it was the work of my good old friend, for it was his purse that I held in my hand.